

A SUPER SESSION DEBRIEF

AI at Events: From Ideas to Action.

What Henry Coutinho-Mason, Tracy Judge, and Vamshi Velmajala told event teams about moving beyond templates, redesigning roles, and reimagining what an event can be.

SOURCE SESSION**AI and the future normal: A super session****DATE & STAGE****20 May 2026 · Rise****FORMAT****75-minute super session****Henry Coutinho-Mason**

Future Normal

Tracy Judge

Soundings Connect

Vamshi Velmajala

Snapsight

The takeaway in one line.

The speakers agreed that the biggest risk in AI is not the tools; it is that event teams keep using them to do the old job a little faster. The invitation, across all three talks, was to redraw the work: map how it actually gets done, split roles that no longer fit, and design for outcomes instead of templates.

Tracy Judge framed AI as fundamentally a change management challenge. Vamshi Velmajala showed how event-specific tools (Spark, Snapsight, Impact AIQ) get real traction only when generic capability is broken into concrete jobs to be done. Henry Coutinho-Mason closed by arguing AI's biggest gift to events is not efficiency; it is that anyone in the room, and anyone in the organisation, can now put an idea on the table.

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AI transformation, it's deeply human. So how you feel about it, one, is okay. And also, it's all about change management, and change management within organizations and bringing everyone along on this journey.

TRACY JUDGE · Soundings Connect

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If the goal is to create a document or create a PPT with an AI, we are barking up the

90M →**4K →**

From ideas to **action**: six moves for your next event.

01

Map how the work actually gets done.

Before you buy another tool, have every team member write out their job step by step. That map is where the real AI opportunities appear, not on the leadership deck.

Tracy Judge: "Really start thinking and mapping out, 'How do I do my job? What are the steps of it?' Write that down and follow along, because that's how you're going to realize where you can use AI in your workflows and your processes."

02

Start with communication, not content strategy.

Real usage data from 15,000 Spark users showed two tasks dominate: composing email and writing LinkedIn posts. Build the daily habit first; sophistication follows.

Vamshi Velmajala: "Whenever I open my dashboard to see what are people really using it for, two tasks: composing email and writing a LinkedIn post."

03

Question the shape of every event role.

Roles built for a pre-AI world often bundle opposite skills. Look at your event technology specialists and attendee managers: is that one job, or two?

Tracy Judge: "Does the job description you have today make sense the way that it is, or should it be split out into different roles? AI is really going to impact how we build teams and how we build roles."

04

Design for outcomes, retire the templates.

PDFs, PPTs, Word docs are inheritances from earlier tech constraints. Decide what attendees, sponsors, and policymakers need to feel or do, then pick the format.

Vamshi Velmajala: "Think of an outcome. What is an outcome that you want to do with it, rather than how it should specifically look. The UI/UX doesn't matter. What you want from it really matters."

05

Connect your stack, stop copy-pasting.

The next wave of value comes from AI reasoning across Gmail, Notion, Calendar, HubSpot and your event platform, not from isolated chatbots. Audit which of your tools can actually talk to each other.

Vamshi Velmajala: "These tools are no longer working in isolation. When you want to reason across something, you are actually reasoning across multiple tools and then you are getting an output. That is the workflow that we are

06

Democratise the "next idea" for your event.

Front-line staff see problems every day but rarely pitch solutions. Use AI as a creative copilot so cloakroom, ops and coordinators can turn observations into shareable concepts, not just leadership.

Henry Coutinho-Mason: "It's not just about more ideas. It's about who gets to share their